

Hapi's Havoc – Full Rulebook (Narrative Edition • Draft 2)

“When Hapi swells the Nile, only the clever endure.”

— Inscription atop the Temple of Amun, Year 7 of Pharaoh Nifehotep

“He who rides the sea of the Nile must have sails woven of patience.”

Welcome, Master Builder!

In *Hapi's Havoc* you and a rival architect have been granted one royal decree: raise the grandest pyramid before the next flood season. To do so you will guide crews of workers, sail nimble river-runner boats through an ever-shifting Nile, and off-load stone and timber onto hefty cargo barges docked at your riverside compound.

Your objective is simple to say and deliciously tricky to achieve: be the first to cap your pyramid and score the most glory.

If you have played modern classics like *Cascadia* or *Dorfromantik*, expect a similar “easy teach, crunchy choices” feel—only here the board itself won't sit still!

1 Contents of the Box

Flip open the lid and you should find:

- 52 River Tiles (double-sided): meandering blue paths on one face, treacherous red obstacles on the reverse.
- 1 Temple Dice-Tower (shared component). It doubles as a card vault and rolls our custom Storm dice.
- 8 Workers – 4 per player, carved as reed-cutters brandishing ropes. (Option to hire more Workers during gameplay is under testing.)
- River Fleet – each colour gets 2 River-runner tokens (for the Nile) and 2 Cargo Barges (large, slot-ridden, to sit in the dock recess of your player board).
- Resource tokens – Stone blocks, Wood planks, and Food baskets. (Food is used to perform actions and bid for initiative, but does not give any victory points at the end of the game.)

- Ability deck – 52 cards of blessings, curses, and river tricks.
- 10 Sphinx markers – worth 3 VP each for those who appease the gods.
- Player Boards with a recessed dock, warehouse track, personal Build Site, and a raised 3-D pyramid grid.
- Rule reference sheet – keep it handy for icons.

Take a minute to savour the laser-engraved wood grain—your workers do fine craft! Ready to build? Let's set up.

2 Setting the Scene (Setup)

1. **The Nile forms:** Shuffle all River Tiles blue (passable) side up and lay out a 6 × 6 grid in the centre of the table.
2. **Personal estates:** Each player takes a board, slots both Cargo Barges into the long dock, puts 2 River-runners on the starting port tile, places 4 Food baskets in their warehouse, and takes **4 Workers**.
3. **Temple prep:** Stack the Ability deck face-down inside the temple tower; drop the three blue Storm dice and the single red Obstacle die nearby.
4. **First flood's favour:** Both roll a blue die; high roll becomes Start Player. *Re-roll ties until there is a clear winner.*

(If you prefer to teach as you play, do steps 1-2 and explain the rest when the first Storm hits.)

3 A Year in the Life – Round Structure

Each round has six beats. Think of them as sunrise to sunset along the banks:

1. **Storm** – the Nile rearranges itself.
2. **Assign Workers** – spend Food to claim shared action spots.
3. **Sail River-runners** – weave through new paths and avoid red tiles.

4. **Warehouse Time** – load/unload Barges and tally today's haul.

Warehouse Extensions

- Each player starts with **9 storage slots** in their Warehouse.
 - You may upgrade your Warehouse by paying **1 Wood + 1 Food** for each additional slot (up to 12 total slots).
 - Extensions are permanent and marked with tokens or counters.
You may purchase extensions during **Warehouse Time** after unloading.
5. **Construction** – extend ramps or hoist stone onto the pyramid.
 6. **Initiative Feast** – whoever spent (or saved) the most Food decides who leads at dawn.

Play repeats until someone places their 14th stone. Then you'll take stock of glory.

4 Phase by Phase (with Examples)

4.1 Storm – Hapi Rolls the Dice

The Start Player tips all four dice down the temple chute. The results show two rows (1-6).

For each die:

- Pick left or right bank of that row.
- Slide in a fresh tile—blue side for blue dice, red side for the red die. All tiles in that row shift one space; the far-edge tile pops off.
- If a River-runner was on the ejected tile, push it **one row back** onto the new edge tile then roll an **obstacle die**.

You may brave several connected obstacles in a single move, but you roll **once for every obstacle tile entered**. When entering an obstacle, you must continue straight ahead (no turning within obstacles).

Obstacle Die Results

- **1–3** → Choose one occupied cargo slot (excluding Workers).
 - If it contains Stone → it becomes **Damaged**.

- If it contains other resources → all contents in that slot are lost.
- **4–6** → Nothing happens — lucky passage.

Workers are never affected by Obstacle rolls.

“Only the gods decide what the river spares.”

Example: A blue die shows Row 4. You push in a blue tile from the left. Julia’s River-runner is shoved off the right edge. It drifts back to the new rightmost tile, she rolls a 2, and must drop 1 Wood from her matching Barge.

4.2 Assign Workers – Feeding the Crew

Workers are hungry! Except for **Gather Food**, each worker you place costs **1 Food** immediately.

Workers are placed **one at a time in alternating turn order, starting with the Start Player**.

Space Slot	Effect	Cost
Quarry Stone (4)	Gain 1 Stone token	1 Food
Cut Wood (4)	Gain 2 Wood	1 Food
Gather Food (4)	Gain 4 Food	Free
Pray (1)	Draw 1 Ability card (hand max 3)	1 Food
Build Site (personal)	Either place 1 Stone or extend ramp (see 4.5)	1 Food

Upgrade Barge (free) Pay **1 Wood + 1 Food** to **unlock a cargo slot** or add **1 Warehouse slot** —

Players take turns **placing Workers one at a time** until all have been placed. *No actions are resolved during this phase.*

Worker Resolution Phase: After all Workers are placed, each player resolves their own actions in any order. You may process your actions simultaneously or step-by-step.

Workers remain in place until the end of the round.

4.3 Sail River-runners

Each of your two River-runner tokens may move **once**. Cargo Barges do not move — they remain docked on your player board.

Boat Layout (In Testing)

- Each boat is divided into **3 rows of 2 slots**.
- Workers are stored separately and do not impact cargo capacity, but they do occupy space.
- **Movement speed** is calculated based on rows filled: every **full row of cargo** reduces speed by 1 (Base Speed = 4).

Resource Type	Slot Size	Example
Stone	1 Slot	1 Stone fits in 1 slot
Wood	0.5 Slot	2 Wood fit in 1 slot
Food	0.25 Slot	4 Food fit in 1 slot

- Players may distribute resources freely within the slots, but each *row filled* reduces

speed.

- River-runners may dock at **any tile** along either riverbank, regardless of where their Cargo Barges are. Multiple River-runners can share the same river tile or dock tile without penalty. **Embarking or disembarking Workers is free during Warehouse Time.**

Packing tip: You may choose to load *less* than the full amount in a cargo slot (e.g., 1 Wood instead of 2, or 2 Food instead of 4). This increases your total slot count (slowing your boat), but can reduce losses if you hit an obstacle — only one slot is affected per 1-3 roll.

Example: Your runner carries 2 Stone, 3 Wood, and 4 Food:

Slot usage = 2 (Stone) + 1.5 (Wood) + 1 (Food) = 4.5 → rounds to 5 slots → Speed = 4 - 2 = **2 tiles**.

4.4 Warehouse Time

Collect resources from workers; freely move tokens between docked Barges and your warehouse. Discard down to 3 cards.

4.5 Construction – Ramps & Pyramid

At each Build Site worker:

- **Extend Ramp:** pay Wood equal to the next level's cost (3/5/7) and place a ramp segment.
- **Place Stone:** move 1 Stone from warehouse onto the highest reachable cell. Damaged Stone may be placed normally, but is worth only **1 VP** instead of 2.

***Pyramid Layer Reward (In Testing):**

*The first player to complete a **full layer** of the pyramid receives **1 Sphinx Marker** (worth 3 VP).*

*If both players finish the same layer in the same Construction phase, the Sphinx goes to the player with **initiative**.*

This is currently being tested for game balance and may be adjusted based on play-test feedback.

4.6 Initiative Feast

As you pay Food for actions, place those tokens on the **Feast Track**. You may spend **extra Food** at any time during your turn to push farther along the track.

- At round end, the player furthest ahead on the track chooses to be **Start** or **Second** next round. (Tie → the marker already on top retains order.)
- After initiative is decided, **return all Food** from the track to the supply.

“A grand feast wins more allies than a silent granary.”

5 Ability Cards & Costs

Players may play **any number of cards**, but only in the windows *between* phases (never during an action).

Card Play Windows

1. **Before Storm Phase** — weather-control cards (e.g., *Calm Waters* **must be played before any dice are rolled**).
2. After Storm, before Worker Assignment — map-manipulation or worker boosters.
3. After Worker Assignment, before Sailing — movement upgrades or safe-passage cards.
4. After Sailing, before Warehouse Time — last-minute maneuvers.
5. After Warehouse Time, before Construction — building or resource tricks.

Thematic Name	Simple Type	Copies	Cost	Effect	Flavor Text
Hapi's Fury	Storm	12	1 Food	Roll both Storm dice again and resolve immediately.	“He sends the waters twice, that none may forget him.”
Twist of the Nile	Rotate Tile	8	Free	Rotate any river tile 180°.	“The Nile bends for no one... except those who listen.”

Turn of the Tide	Flip Tile	8	Free	Flip any river tile to its opposite side.	"What once was safe may sink, and what once was sunk may rise."
Wind of Horus	+2 Move	6	Free	One River-runner gains +2 speed this round.	"Horus lifts the sails of the bold."
Isis' Protection	Safe Passage	6	Free	A River-runner ignores all red-tile penalties this round.	"She wraps your boat in silence and shadow."
Strength of Ra	Double Worker	4	1 Food	One Worker you place this round produces double.	"One man, blazing with the fire of noon."
Calm Waters	Skip Storm	3	2 Food	Skip the entire Storm phase this round.	"Peace flows where Hapi slumbers."
Curse of Anubis	Plague	2	2 Food	Both players halve their Food (round down).	"He walks in the grain-fields. He does not walk alone."
Decree of Set	Block Action	2	Discard 1	Choose an unused action; it is blocked this round.	"Chaos signs your orders in blood."
Wrath of Bastet	Strike	1	Discard 1	Opponent removes two unassigned Workers.	"Even cats may rise when the sun forgets them."

Hand limit: 3 cards (checked at the end of Warehouse Time).

Bonus:** Discard **3 Storm** cards at any time to gain a **Sphinx** (worth 3 VP).

A card's cost icon is printed top-left for quick scanning.

6 End of the Game & Scoring

The moment a player places the **14th Stone**, finish the current round and tally:

- **2 VP** per *Undamaged Stone* in your pyramid.
- **1 VP** per *Damaged Stone*.
- **5 VP** to the player who finished first (if both finish the same round, the player with initiative earns this bonus).
- **3 VP** per *Sphinx* marker.

Highest total wins. Ties are shared—historians will remember both pyramids as co-wonders.

7 Designer Notes & Tips

- **Speed isn't everything** – a lightly loaded runner darting 4-5 tiles can sneak past red tiles and save you Food lost to damage.
 - **Timing the Feast** – Sometimes overspending Food to nab Start Player next round keeps a clutch Build Site open for you.
 - **Kind Fate or Cruel?** – Encourage new players to save Rotate/Flip cards for moments their runner gets boxed in.
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Thanks for joining the early builders' guild! Questions or feedback?
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